

A CLEAN GOAL

HPCL has set an ambitious target to become a net zero energy provider

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PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE

► **PUBLIC SECTOR** giant Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) has been focused on sustainability for years. It first started using wind power as far back as 2006. But the real thrust was a while away.

P. S. Murty, Executive Director (Health, Safety & Environment) and a company veteran, admits that the focus on sustainability took off on the back of poor ESG (environmental, social and governance) ratings. That was in 2020-21. "It has been an eventful period since then and we have covered a lot of distance," he says. Today, ESG moves all aspects of the organisation's strategy. For instance, for the field staff, 2% weight in key performance indicators is given to their green contribution. "The thinking must continuously evolve," he says.

The change over the last few years has been dramatic. "To that extent, the phase has been quite remarkable," says Murty. The core business of HPCL has been refining crude oil and marketing petroleum products apart from exploring and producing hydrocarbons. The realisation on sustainability threw open an opportunity for the company to completely reorient itself. The new environment meant HPCL would need to move from being a fuel company to becoming an energy company. Sound simple? Not really. "We have always been a low-profile and

